

Ann's Candle Durham

Transforming a bare HTML page into a fully SEO-optimised website

BUSINESS

Ann's Candle Durham

LOCATION

Durham, UK

FOCUS

On-page, Technical & Local SEO

TYPE

Static HTML Website

01 Project Overview

This case study focuses on optimising a basic HTML website for search engine visibility. Ann's Candle Durham (a fictional shop) is a startup candle business that launched with a simple HTML page entirely lacking SEO structure.

The objective was to transform the website into a fully SEO-friendly page by implementing on-page, technical, and local SEO best practices – covering metadata, content structure, keyword placement, schema markup, internal linking, image optimisation, and local SEO signals.

02 Business Background

Ann's Candle Durham is a handmade candle business in Durham, UK, offering scented candles, soy wax candles, and handmade gift candles. The business launched with a minimal HTML page that had no SEO optimisation.

Challenges identified:

No meta tags	No structured headings	No keyword targeting
No local SEO signals	No schema markup	Poor crawlability
No internal linking	Missing alt text for images	Limited search visibility

03 SEO Goals

Primary Goals

Make the HTML page SEO-friendly
Improve search engine crawlability
Add keyword targeting
Optimise page structure
Implement local SEO signals

Secondary Goals

Improve Durham search relevance
Add structured data
Improve user experience
Optimise images
Add internal linking

Target Keywords:

handmade candles Durham	scented candles Durham	soy candles Durham	candle gifts Durham	handmade gift candles UK
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04 Methodology

1	SEO Audit	Analysed existing HTML structure and identified all SEO gaps across on-page, technical, and local dimensions.
2	Keyword Research	Selected location-based and product-based keywords aligned with user search intent for Durham searches.
3	On-page Optimisation	Improved headings, content structure, keyword placement, and internal link architecture.
4	Technical SEO Implementation	Added meta tags, canonical tags, schema markup, and crawl directives.
5	Local SEO Optimisation	Added Durham-based content, business NAP details, and LocalBusiness schema.
6	Performance Optimisation	Optimised images with alt text, lazy loading, and explicit dimensions for faster page load.

05 Tools Used

Google Search Console (monitoring)	Google Analytics (traffic)	HTML Validator
Manual Keyword Research	Schema Markup Generator	Lighthouse (performance)

06 Key Findings

The initial HTML page had numerous SEO deficiencies that prevented it from ranking in search engines:

No title tag optimisation	No meta description	No keyword targeting
Missing H1 tag	No heading hierarchy	No schema markup
No local SEO signals	Images without alt text	No canonical tag
No internal linking	No structured content	No Open Graph tags

07 Implementation

The following SEO elements were implemented across the HTML page:

SEO Item	Type	Location	Purpose	Example Code
Title Tag	On-page	<head>	Page ranking title	<title>Ann's Candle Durham...</title>
Meta Description	On-page	<head>	SERP description	<meta name="description" content="Handmade candles Durham">
Meta Keywords	On-page	<head>	Keyword targeting	<meta name="keywords" content="candles Durham">

SEO Item	Type	Location	Purpose	Example Code
Robots Meta Tag	Technical	<head>	Crawl/index control	<meta name="robots" content="index, follow">
Canonical Tag	On-page	<head>	Avoid duplicate pages	<link rel="canonical" href="https://...">
Language Tag	On-page	<html>	Language targeting	<html lang="en-GB">
Hreflang Tag	On-page	<head>	Geo targeting	<link rel="alternate" hreflang="en-gb">
Viewport	Technical	<head>	Mobile friendly	<meta name="viewport"...>
Heading Structure	On-page	Body	Content hierarchy	<h1> <h2> <h3>
Keyword Optimisation	On-page	Content	Ranking keywords	Handmade candles in Durham
Image Optimisation	On-page		Image SEO	
Lazy Loading	Technical		Page speed	loading="lazy"
Internal Links	On-page	Navigation	Site crawl	
SEO URL Structure	Technical	Canonical	Clean URLs	/handmade-candles-durham
Breadcrumb Nav	On-page	Body top	Navigation SEO	<nav aria-label="breadcrumb">
Breadcrumb Schema	Technical	JSON-LD	Rich snippets	"@type": "BreadcrumbList"
LocalBusiness Schema	Technical	JSON-LD	Local SEO	"@type": "LocalBusiness"
FAQ Schema	Technical	JSON-LD	Voice search	"@type": "FAQPage"
Open Graph Tags	On-page	<head>	Social sharing	og:title
Twitter Card	On-page	<head>	Twitter preview	twitter:card
Google Analytics	Technical	<head> script	Traffic tracking	gtag('config', 'G-123')
Facebook Pixel	Technical	<head> script	Ad tracking	fbq('track', 'PageView')
Video Optimisation	On-page	Products	Video SEO	<video controls>
External Links	Off-page	About	Authority signal	
Social Links	Off-page	Contact	Brand signals	Facebook / Instagram links
Voice Search Content	On-page	FAQ	Conversational SEO	"Where can I buy..."
Navigation Menu	On-page	Header	Internal linking	<nav>
Contact NAP	Local SEO	Contact	Local ranking	Phone + address
Mobile Friendly	Technical	Viewport	Mobile SEO	responsive meta
Structured Data	Technical	JSON-LD	Rich results	<script type="application/ld+json">
Alt Attributes	On-page	Images	Accessibility + SEO	alt="..."
Footer Links	On-page	Footer	Crawl depth	privacy links
Email Link	Technical	Contact	Conversion	mailto:
Phone Link	Technical	Contact	Mobile SEO	tel:

08 Recommendations

On-page SEO

Technical SEO

Local SEO

Add optimised title tag
Add meta description Add
keyword-rich headings
Optimise content with
keywords Add internal links
Add alt text to images

Add canonical tag Add
robots meta tag Add
schema markup Add Open
Graph tags Add mobile
viewport tag

Add Durham location
content Add business
address Add phone number
(NAP) Add LocalBusiness
schema Add FAQ section

09 Priority Action Plan

High Priority	Medium Priority	Low Priority
Optimise title tag Add meta description Add H1 heading Add keywords in content Optimise images	Add schema markup Add internal links Add FAQ section Add canonical tag	Add social tags Add breadcrumb schema Add Open Graph tags

10 Expected Results

After implementing all SEO improvements, the website is expected to achieve:

Improved search visibility across target keywords	Rank for Durham-based local search queries
Improved crawlability by search engines	Enhanced user experience and navigation
Increase in organic traffic over time	Stronger local SEO presence in Durham
Support for future content expansion	

11 Conclusion

This project demonstrates how a basic HTML page can be transformed into a search engine optimised website. By implementing on-page, technical, and local SEO strategies, the Ann's Candle Durham website was structured for improved search visibility and organic growth.

The optimisation ensures that search engines can properly crawl, understand, and rank the website, while also improving user experience and local search relevance — a foundation that scales effectively as the business grows.

Full HTML comparison: before (no SEO) and after (fully optimised). Code is syntax-highlighted so each element type is easy to identify.

BEFORE — NO SEO

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<title>Anns Candle</title>
</head>
<body>
<h1>Ann's Candle</h1>
<p>Handmade candles in Durham.</p>
<h2>Our Products</h2>
<h3>Lavender Candle</h3>
<p>Relaxing lavender scented candle.</p>
<h3>Vanilla Candle</h3>
<p>Sweet vanilla fragrance candle.</p>
<h2>Contact</h2>
<p>Email: annscandle@gmail.com</p>
<p>Location: Durham, UK</p>
</body>
</html>
```

AFTER — SEO OPTIMISED

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
<meta charset="UTF-8">
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
<title>Ann's Candle Durham | Handmade Scented Candles in Durham UK</title>
<meta name="description" content="Ann's Candle Durham offers handmade scented candles in Durham UK. Buy soy candles, lavender candles and gifts.">
<meta name="keywords" content="candles Durham, handmade candles UK, soy candles Durham, scented candles Durham">
<meta name="robots" content="index, follow">
<meta name="author" content="Ann's Candle Durham">
<link rel="canonical" href="https://www.annscandle.com/">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="en-gb" href="https://www.annscandle.com/">
<!-- Open Graph -->
<meta property="og:title" content="Ann's Candle Durham">
<meta property="og:description" content="Handmade scented candles in Durham UK">
<meta property="og:type" content="website">
<meta property="og:url" content="https://www.annscandle.com">
<meta property="og:image" content="https://www.annscandle.com/images/candle.jpg">
<!-- Twitter Card -->
<meta name="twitter:card" content="summary_large_image">
<meta name="twitter:title" content="Ann's Candle Durham">
<meta name="twitter:description" content="Handmade scented candles in Durham UK">
<meta name="twitter:image" content="https://www.annscandle.com/images/candle.jpg">
<!-- Google Analytics -->
<script async src="https://www.googletagmanager.com/gtag/js?id=G-1234567890"></script>
<script>
window.dataLayer = window.dataLayer || [];
function gtag(){dataLayer.push(arguments);}
gtag('js', new Date());
```

```

<script>
  gtag('config', 'G-1234567890');
</script>
<!-- Facebook Pixel -->
<script>
  !function(f,b,e,v,n,t,s)
  {if(f.fbq)return;n=f.fbq=function(){n.callMethod?
  n.callMethod.apply(n,arguments):n.queue.push(arguments)};
  if(!f._fbq)f._fbq=n;n.push=n;n.loaded=!0;n.version='2.0';
  n.queue=[];t=b.createElement(e);t.async=!0;t.src=v;
  s=b.getElementsByTagName(e)[0];
  s.parentNode.insertBefore(t,s)}
  (window,document,'script','https://connect.facebook.net/en_US/fbevents.js');
  fbq('init', '123456789012345');
  fbq('track', 'PageView');
</script>
</head>
<body>
<header>
<h1>Ann's Candle Durham</h1>
<nav>
<a href="#home">Home</a>
<a href="#products">Products</a>
<a href="#about">About</a>
<a href="#contact">Contact</a>
</nav>
</header>
<!-- Breadcrumb -->
<nav aria-label="breadcrumb">
<a href="/">Home</a> >
<a href="#products">Products</a> >
Handmade Candles
</nav>
<section id="home">
<h2>Handmade Candles in Durham UK</h2>
<p>Ann's Candle Durham creates handmade scented candles using eco friendly soy wax.
Perfect for gifts, home decor and relaxation.</p>
</section>
<section id="products">
<h2>Our Scented Candles</h2>
<article>
<h3>Lavender Soy Candle</h3>

<p>Relaxing lavender scented candle handmade in Durham.</p>
</article>
<article>
<h3>Vanilla Scented Candle</h3>

<p>Sweet vanilla scented candle perfect for home fragrance.</p>
</article>
</section>
<section id="about">
<h2>About Ann's Candle Durham</h2>
<p>Ann's Candle Durham is a local handmade candle brand based in Durham UK.
We create eco friendly soy candles with premium fragrance oils.</p>
</section>
<section id="contact">
<h2>Contact Ann's Candle Durham</h2>
<p>Email: info@annscandle.com</p>
<p>Phone: 07123456789</p>
<p>Location: Durham, United Kingdom</p>
</section>

```

```

<footer>
<p>© 2026 Ann's Candle Durham</p>
</footer>
<!-- Local Business Schema -->
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
"@context": "https://schema.org",
"@type": "LocalBusiness",
"name": "Ann's Candle Durham",
"image": "https://www.annscandle.com/images/candle.jpg",
"url": "https://www.annscandle.com",
"telephone": "07123456789",
"address": {
"@type": "PostalAddress",
"streetAddress": "Durham",
"addressLocality": "Durham",
"addressRegion": "UK",
"postalCode": "DH1",
"addressCountry": "GB"
},
"sameAs": [
"https://facebook.com/annscandle",
"https://instagram.com/annscandle"
]
}
</script>
<!-- Breadcrumb Schema -->
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
"@context": "https://schema.org",
"@type": "BreadcrumbList",
"itemListElement": [{
"@type": "ListItem",
"position": 1,
"name": "Home",
"item": "https://www.annscandle.com"
},{
"@type": "ListItem",
"position": 2,
"name": "Products",
"item": "https://www.annscandle.com/#products"
},{
"@type": "ListItem",
"position": 3,
"name": "Handmade Candles"
}]
}
</script>
</body>
</html>

```